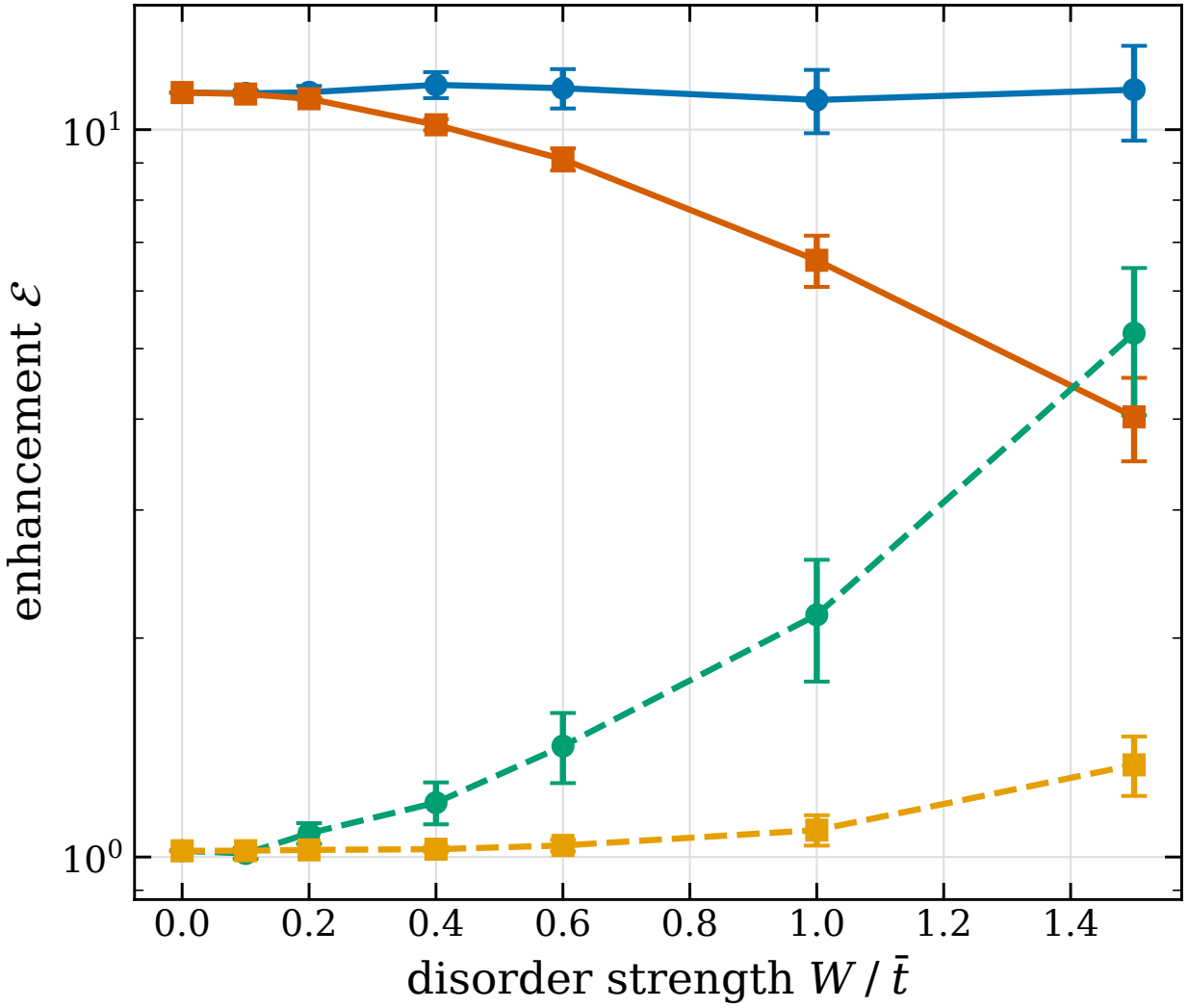

trivial controls stay near unity for $W \lesssim 0.4\,\bar{t}$: the effect is topological, not merely gapped